

ON THE EO-ORIENTABILITY OF VECTOR BUNDLES

P. BHATTACHARYA AND H. CHATHAM

ABSTRACT. We study the orientability of vector bundles with respect to a family of cohomology theories called EO-theories. The EO-theories are higher height analogues of real K-theory KO. For each EO-theory, we prove that the direct sum of i copies of any vector bundle is EO-orientable for some specific integer i . Using a splitting principal, we reduce to the case of the canonical line bundle over $\mathbb{CP}^\infty$. Our method involves understanding the action of an order p subgroup of the Morava stabilizer group on the Morava E-theory of $\mathbb{CP}^\infty$. Our calculations have another application: We determine the homotopy type of the S^1 -Tate spectrum associated to the trivial action of S^1 on all EO-theories.

1. Introduction

A real vector bundle ξ is called orientable with respect to a cohomology theory E if it cannot distinguish between ξ and the trivial vector bundle of the same dimension over the same base space, which we will denote by $\epsilon^{\dim \xi}$. In other words, there is an E -Thom isomorphism

$$E \wedge \mathrm{Th}(\xi) \simeq E \wedge \mathrm{Th}(\epsilon^{\dim \xi})$$

where $\mathrm{Th}(\xi)$ denotes the Thom space associated to ξ (see (2.1)). The study of the orientability of vector bundles with respect to cohomology theories has led to foundational results in both geometry and algebraic topology. For example, the HF_2 -orientability of all vector bundles leads to the notion of Stiefel-Whitney classes and the $\mathrm{H}\mathbb{Z}$ -orientability of complex vector bundles leads to Chern classes. It is a standard fact that all complex vector bundles are KU -orientable, however, not all of them are KO -orientable. The following examples motivate some of the work in this paper.

Example 1.1. The complex tautological line bundle γ^1 over $\mathbb{CP}^1 \simeq S^2$ is not KO -orientable because the Thom isomorphism fails:

$$\mathrm{KO} \wedge \mathrm{Th}(\gamma^1) \not\simeq \mathrm{KO} \wedge \mathrm{Th}(\epsilon^2).$$

On one hand, $\mathrm{Th}(\gamma^1) \simeq \mathbb{CP}^2$ (see Example 2.3) and $\mathrm{KO} \wedge \mathbb{CP}^2 \simeq \mathrm{KU}$. On the other hand, $\mathrm{Th}(\epsilon^2) \simeq \Sigma^2 \mathbb{CP}_+^1 \simeq S^2 \vee S^4$ (see Example 2.2) and $\mathrm{KO} \wedge \mathrm{Th}(\epsilon^2) \simeq \Sigma^2 \mathrm{KO} \vee \Sigma^4 \mathrm{KO}$.

Example 1.2. While γ^1 is not KO -orientable, its 2-fold direct sum $\gamma^1 \oplus \gamma^1$ is. In fact, $\xi^{\oplus 2}$ is KO -orientable for every complex vector bundle ξ (see Lemma 2.18).

From the point of view of chromatic homotopy theory, 2-completed KO is part of a family of cohomology theories called the EO-theories. Associated to each

finite height formal group Γ over a perfect field $\mathbb{F}$ of characteristic p , there is an associated Morava E-theory E_Γ with an action of $\text{Aut}(\Gamma)$, often called the small Morava Stabilizer group. When the cyclic group of order p acts faithfully on Γ , we define the spectrum EO_Γ as the homotopy fixed point spectrum

$$EO_\Gamma := E_\Gamma^{\text{h}C_p}.$$

Example 1.3. When $p = 2$ and $\widehat{\mathbb{G}}_m$ is the multiplicative formal group over $\mathbb{F}_2$, there is a canonical action of C_2 on $\widehat{\mathbb{G}}_m$. In this case, $E_{\widehat{\mathbb{G}}_m} \simeq KU_2^\wedge$ and $EO_{\widehat{\mathbb{G}}_m} \simeq KO_2^\wedge$.

Remark 1.4. Let n denote the height of the formal group Γ . If $p - 1$ divides n and the base field $\mathbb{F}$ of Γ is algebraically closed, then $\text{Aut}(\Gamma)$ contains a subgroup of order p which is unique up to conjugation. If $\mathbb{F}$ is not algebraically closed then any number of conjugacy classes of subgroups of order p (including zero) is possible depending on Γ . If $p - 1$ does not divide n , then $\text{Aut}(\Gamma)$ does not contain any subgroup of order p (see [Ser67]).

The main goal of this paper is to prove the following result:

Main Theorem 1.5. *Let p be a prime and $k > 0$. The p^{p^k-1} -fold direct sum of any $\mathbb{C}$ -vector bundle is EO_Γ -orientable if the height of formal group Γ is $(p-1)k$.*

For a ring spectrum R , the R -orientation order of a vector bundle ξ , denoted by $\Theta(R, \xi)$, is the smallest positive integer d for which the d -fold direct sum is R -orientable (see Definition 2.9 and Remark 2.10).

The proof of Main Theorem 1.5 reduces to the study of a single vector bundle, namely the tautological line bundle γ over $\mathbb{CP}^\infty$, because of a splitting principle which asserts that $\Theta(\xi, R)$ divides $\Theta(\gamma, R)$ for any $\mathbb{C}$ -vector bundle ξ (see Lemma 2.18). Thus, Main Theorem 1.5 follows from the following result.

Main Theorem 1.6. $\Theta(\gamma, EO_\Gamma)$ divides p^{p^k-1} .

Main Theorem 1.6 is a consequence of the study of the action of $C_p \subset \text{Aut}(\Gamma)$ on $E_\Gamma^*\mathbb{CP}^\infty$. We first show that $E_\Gamma^*\mathbb{CP}^\infty$ admits a “Free $\oplus$ Finite” decomposition as a C_p -module (see Corollary 4.4). Then, using the relative Adams spectral sequence [BL01] we lift this algebraic splitting to obtain the following EO_Γ -module splitting:

Main Theorem 1.7. *In the category of EO_Γ -modules there is a splitting*

$$EO_\Gamma \wedge \mathbb{CP}_+^\infty \simeq \mathcal{M} \vee \mathcal{F},$$

where $\mathcal{M}$ is a compact EO_Γ -module and $\mathcal{F} \simeq \bigvee_{\mathbb{N}} E_\Gamma$ is a wedge of Morava E-theories.

Further, we show that the inclusion map

$$\mathcal{M} \longrightarrow EO_\Gamma \wedge \mathbb{CP}_+^\infty$$

of the compact summand factors through $EO_\Gamma \wedge \mathbb{CP}_+^{p^{k+1}-p^k-1}$ (see Lemma 4.20). Consequently

$$\Theta(EO_\Gamma, \gamma) = \Theta(EO_\Gamma, \gamma^{p^{k+1}-p^k-1}),$$

where γ^d is the restriction of γ to $\mathbb{CP}^d$ (see [Corollary 4.26](#)). Atiyah and Todd [\[AT60\]](#) computed $\Theta(\mathbb{S}, \gamma^d)$ for all d which serves as an upper bound for $\Theta(\text{EO}_\Gamma, \gamma^d)$ and leads to [Main Theorem 1.6](#) (see [Example 2.13](#)).

Let $K_\Gamma := E_\Gamma/\mathfrak{m}$ denote the associated Morava K-theory. As an application of [Main Theorem 1.7](#), we prove:

Main Theorem 1.8. *Let S^1 act trivially on EO_Γ . There is a K_Γ -local equivalence*

$$\text{EO}_\Gamma^{\text{t}S^1} \simeq \prod_{-\infty < k < \infty} E_\Gamma.$$

Remark 1.9. [Main Theorem 1.7](#) is a generalization of the splitting [\[GM95, §15\]](#)

$$(1.10) \quad \text{KO} \wedge \mathbb{CP}_+^\infty \simeq \text{KO} \vee \bigvee_{k \geq 1} \Sigma^{4k-2} \text{KU}$$

and [Main Theorem 1.8](#) is a generalization of the fact that

$$\text{KO}^{\text{t}S^1} \simeq \prod_{-\infty < k < \infty} \text{KU}.$$

Remark 1.11. The second author studied EO_Γ -orientations when Γ has height $p-1$ in his previous work. He proved [\[Cha19, Corollary 1.6\]](#) that in this case

$$\Theta(\text{EO}_\Gamma, \gamma) = p.$$

Thus, when $n = p-1$ our bound is not sharp.

Remark 1.12. At $p=2$, Kitchloo, Lorman and Wilson [\[KLW16, KW15\]](#) studied a similar problem. There is a C_2 -action on height n Johnson-Wilson theory $E(n)$. The C_2 fixed points are commonly called real Johnson-Wilson theory, denoted $\text{ER}(n)$. In [\[KLW16, KW15\]](#), the authors use genuine C_2 -equivariant homotopy theory to deduce that $\Theta(\text{ER}(n), \gamma) = 2^n$. Hahn and Shi [\[HS17\]](#) proved that there is a homotopy ring map $\text{ER}(n) \rightarrow \text{EO}_\Gamma$, where Γ is any height n formal group over a perfect field of characteristic 2. Combining these facts one concludes that $\Theta(\text{EO}_\Gamma, \gamma)$ divides 2^n when Γ has height n . Thus, when $p=2$ our bound on $\Theta(\text{EO}_\Gamma, \gamma)$ is not sharp.

We conjecture:

Conjecture 1.13. *If the height of the formal group Γ is $n = (p-1)k$, then $\Theta(\text{EO}_\Gamma, \mathbb{C}) = p^k$.*

A commutative ring spectrum R is called complex orientable if γ is R -orientable. In our language, R is complex orientable if and only if $\Theta(R, \gamma) = 1$. Quillen proved that an R -orientation of γ is equivalent data to a homotopy ring map $\text{MU} \rightarrow R$ (see [\[Ada74, Part II, Lemma 4.6\]](#) and [\[Rav86, Lemma 4.1.13\]](#) for a statement). Let $\text{MU}[n]$ be the Thom spectrum of the map

$$\varphi_n: \text{BU} \rightarrow \text{BU}$$

given by multiplication by n in the additive $\mathbb{E}_\infty$ -structure. If R is a ring spectrum such that $\Theta(R, \mathbb{C})$ divides n we prove that there is a map $\text{MU}[n] \rightarrow R$ using a theorem of Segal [\[Seg73\]](#) (see [Theorem 2.15](#)). [Main Theorem 1.5](#) and [Theorem 2.15](#) imply the following corollary.

Corollary 1.14. *There exists a map $\text{MU}[n] \rightarrow \text{EO}_\Gamma$ whenever p^{p^k-1} divides n .*

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2. A brief review of orientation theory

The goal of this section is to prove a splitting principle (see [Lemma 2.18](#)) and generalize a result of Quillen (see [Theorem 2.15](#)). We do so after reviewing orientation theory and its connection to chromatic homotopy theory.

Although many of the statements in this section are known to be true more generally for homotopy commutative ring spectra, we restrict to ones with an $\mathbb{E}_\infty$ structure because it is a requirement in the proof of [Theorem 2.15](#) and [Lemma 2.18](#). This is acceptable for our application, namely [Corollary 1.14](#), because EO_Γ is an $\mathbb{E}_\infty$ -ring spectrum.

2.1. Orientation with respect to cohomology theories

Given an $\mathbb{R}$ -vector bundle ξ over a base space B_ξ with total space E_ξ , the Thom space of ξ is defined as the cofiber of the projection map

$$(2.1) \quad \mathrm{Th}(\xi) := \mathrm{Cofib}((E_\xi^\times)_+ \rightarrow B_{\xi+}),$$

where $E_\xi^\times$ denotes the complement of the zero section. The *Thom spectrum* of ξ is the suspension spectrum of $\mathrm{Th}(\xi)$:

$$M(\xi) := \Sigma^\infty \mathrm{Th}(\xi)$$

Example 2.2. When $\xi \cong \epsilon^r$ is a trivial bundle of rank r then

$$\mathrm{Th}(\xi) \simeq \Sigma^r B_{\xi+},$$

where $B_{\xi+}$ is the base space of ξ .

Example 2.3. For the complex tautological line bundle γ^n over $\mathbb{CP}^n$, $\mathrm{Th}(k\gamma^n)$ is equivalent to

$$\mathbb{CP}_+^{n+k} := \mathrm{Cofib}(\mathbb{CP}_+^{k-1} \rightarrow \mathbb{CP}_+^{n+k}),$$

where k is a positive integer and $1 \leq n \leq \infty$.

The notion of Thom space does not extend to virtual vector bundles, but the notion of Thom spectrum does. We recall in brief the construction of Thom spectrum, the Thom isomorphism, and orientation theory for $\mathbb{E}_\infty$ ring spectra following [\[ABG⁺14\]](#). Many of these ideas originated in [\[May77\]](#).

The space of units $\mathrm{GL}_1(R)$ of an $\mathbb{E}_\infty$ ring spectrum R is an $\mathbb{E}_\infty$ space. Consequently, for any space B , the set of homotopy classes of pointed maps $[B_+, \mathrm{BGL}_1(R)]$ forms an abelian group.

For any zero dimensional virtual vector bundle ξ , the composite

$$B_\xi \xrightarrow{f_\xi} BO \xrightarrow{J} BGL_1(\mathbb{S}) \xrightarrow{B(\iota_R)} BGL_1(R),$$

classifies a principal $GL_1(R)$ -bundle $P(\xi, R)$ which is a right $GL_1(R)$ -space where f_ξ is the classifying map, J is the J -homomorphism and ι_R is the unit map of R . The R -Thom spectrum of ξ is defined as the derived smash product

$$M(\xi, R) := P(\xi, R)_+ \wedge_{GL_1(R)_+} R.$$

The above construction of the R -Thom spectrum extends to virtual vector bundles of all dimensions.

Notation 2.4. For a virtual vector bundle ξ of dimension d , let $\xi_0 := \xi - \epsilon^d$ denote the corresponding zero-dimensional bundle. We declare

$$M(\xi, R) := \Sigma^d M(\xi_0, R).$$

We use $M(\xi)$ as a shorthand for $M(\xi, \mathbb{S})$.

There is a natural weak equivalence

$$M(\xi) \wedge R \xrightarrow{\simeq} M(\xi, R).$$

which determines the homotopy type of $M(\xi, R)$.

Notation 2.5. For all $k \in \mathbb{Z}$, let $\mathbb{CP}_k^{n+k}$ denote the Thom spectrum

$$\mathbb{CP}_k^{n+k} := M(k\gamma^n).$$

This extends [Example 2.3](#) to all integers, provided that we consider $\mathbb{CP}_a^b$ to be a spectrum.

An R -orientation of ξ is a choice of trivialization of $P(\xi_0, R)$, or equivalently a choice of null-homotopy of the classifying map

$$B(\iota_R) \circ J \circ f_{\xi_0} : B_\xi \longrightarrow BGL_1(R).$$

Such a null-homotopy leads to an equivalence of R -modules

$$(2.6) \quad M(\xi) \wedge R \simeq \Sigma^d M(\xi_0, R) \simeq \Sigma^d B_{\xi_+} \wedge R,$$

which we refer to as the R -Thom isomorphism.

Dually, an R -orientation for ξ leads to an equivalence of $R^{B_{\xi_+}}$ -modules

$$R^{B_{\xi_+}} \simeq \Sigma^d R^{M(\xi)}$$

which can be regarded as a cohomological version of the R -Thom isomorphism. On π_0 , the above isomorphism sends a map $f : \Sigma^\infty B_{\xi_+} \rightarrow R$ to the composite

$$(2.7) \quad M(\xi) \xrightarrow{\mathbb{1}_{M(\xi)} \wedge \iota_R} M(\xi) \wedge R \xrightarrow{\simeq} \Sigma^d B_{\xi_+} \wedge R \xrightarrow{f \wedge \mathbb{1}_R} \Sigma^d R \wedge R \xrightarrow{\mu_R} \Sigma^d R.$$

When $f : \Sigma^\infty B_+ \rightarrow \mathbb{S} \rightarrow R$ is the composite of the collapse map with the unit of R , we refer to the corresponding element of $R^d(M(\xi))$ as an R -Thom class. It is classical fact that an R -orientation is equivalent to a choice of an R -Thom class.

Remark 2.8. If ξ is R -orientable, then its restriction $\xi^{(k)}$ to the k -th skeleton $B_\xi^{(k)}$ is also R -orientable and the Thom spectrum $M(\xi^{(k)})$ is the $(k + \dim \xi)$ -th skeleton of $M(\xi)$. Thus, any R -Thom isomorphism $\omega: R \wedge M(\xi) \xrightarrow{\simeq} R \wedge \Sigma^d B_+$ preserves the Atiyah-Hirzebruch filtration

$$\omega^{(k)}: R \wedge M(\xi^{(k)}) \xrightarrow{\simeq} R \wedge \Sigma^d B_+^{(k)}.$$

Definition 2.9. For an $\mathbb{E}_\infty$ ring spectrum R , the R -orientation order $\Theta(\xi, R)$ of a virtual vector bundle ξ with base space B_ξ is defined as the order of the class $[B(\iota) \circ J \circ f_{\xi_0}] \in [B_{\xi_+}, BGL_1(R)]$.

Remark 2.10. If $\Theta(\xi, R) = n$, then n is the smallest positive integer for which $n\xi$ is R -orientable. In particular, ξ is R -orientable when $\Theta(\xi, R) = 1$.

Example 2.11. Since $\mathbb{F}_2^\times$ is the trivial group, every vector bundle is $H\mathbb{F}_2$ -orientable. However for $p > 2$, not every bundle is $H\mathbb{F}_p$ -orientable. For example, $H\mathbb{F}_p$ -orientation order of the tautological line bundle over $\mathbb{R}P^\infty$ is 2 (as its $H\mathbb{Z}$ -orientation order is 2).

If a virtual vector bundle ξ is R -orientable and there is a ring map $R \rightarrow T$, then ξ is also T -orientable. In particular, $\Theta(\xi, T)$ divides $\Theta(\xi, R)$.

Remark 2.12. If R is a p -local ring spectrum and ξ is an $H\mathbb{Z}$ -orientable virtual vector bundle over a compact base then $\Theta(\xi, R)$ is a power of p . This is because any p -local ring spectrum admits a ring map $\mathbb{S}_p \rightarrow R$ and $\Theta(\xi, \mathbb{S}_p)$ is a power of p as the higher homotopy groups of $GL_1(\mathbb{S}_p)$ are p -torsion.

Example 2.13. The $\mathbb{S}$ -orientation order of the tautological line bundle γ^n over $\mathbb{C}P^n$ is known for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$ due to work of Atiyah and Todd [AT60] (upper bound) and Adams and Walker [AW65] (lower bound). It is given by the formula

$$\nu_p(\Theta(\gamma^n, \mathbb{S})) = \begin{cases} \max \left\{ r + \nu_p(r) : 1 \leq r \leq \left\lfloor \frac{n}{p-1} \right\rfloor \right\} & \text{if } p \leq n+1 \\ 0 & \text{if } p > n+1, \end{cases}$$

where ν_p is the p -adic valuation.

2.2. Complex n -orientation and the splitting principle

A *complex orientation* of a $\mathbb{E}_\infty$ -ring spectrum R is a choice of an R -Thom class for the tautological complex line bundle γ , i.e. a map

$$u_R: M(\gamma - \epsilon^2) \simeq \Sigma^{-2} \mathbb{C}P^\infty \rightarrow R$$

such that the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathbb{S} & \xrightarrow{\iota_R} & R \\ \downarrow & \nearrow u_R & \\ \Sigma^{-2} \mathbb{C}P^\infty & & \end{array}$$

commutes up to homotopy. One may generalize this definition to the notion of a complex n -orientation as follows.

Definition 2.14. A *complex n -orientation* of an $\mathbb{E}_\infty$ -ring spectrum R is a map

$$u_R: M(n(\gamma - \epsilon^2)) \simeq \Sigma^{-2n} \mathbb{C}\mathbb{P}_n^\infty \rightarrow R$$

such that the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathbb{S} & \xrightarrow{\iota_R} & R \\ \downarrow & \nearrow u_R & \\ \Sigma^{-2n} \mathbb{C}\mathbb{P}_n^\infty & & \end{array}$$

commutes up to homotopy.

Quillen proved that complex orientations of a ring spectrum R are in bijection with homotopy ring maps $u_1: MU \rightarrow R$ (see [Rav86, Lemma 4.1.13] for a proof). Stated differently, Quillen proved that if $\Theta(\gamma, R) = 1$ then $\Theta(\xi, R) = 1$ for any complex vector bundle ξ .

Let $MU[n]$ be the Thom spectrum of the multiplication by n map $\varphi_n: BU \rightarrow BU$. Because φ_n is an $\mathbb{E}_\infty$ -map (with respect to the additive infinite loop structure on BU), $MU[n]$ is an $\mathbb{E}_\infty$ -ring spectrum. We make the following generalization of Quillen's work.

Theorem 2.15. *Let R be an $\mathbb{E}_\infty$ -ring spectrum. There is a one-to-one correspondence between complex n -orientations of R and homotopy classes of unital maps $u_n: MU[n] \rightarrow R$.*

Proof. A complex n -orientation of R is a null-homotopy of the composite

$$\mathbb{C}\mathbb{P}^\infty \xrightarrow{f_\gamma} BU \xrightarrow{\varphi_n} BU \xrightarrow{J_C} BGL_1(\mathbb{S}) \xrightarrow{BGL_1(\iota_R)} BGL_1(R)$$

where J_C is the complex J-homomorphism. Using the fact that BU , $BGL_1(\mathbb{S})$ and $BGL_1(R)$ are $\mathbb{E}_\infty$ -spaces and φ_n , J_C and $BGL_1(\iota_R)$ are $\mathbb{E}_\infty$ -maps, we can extend f_γ to $\tilde{f}_\gamma$

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathbb{C}\mathbb{P}^\infty & \xrightarrow{f_\gamma} & BU \\ \downarrow \iota & \nearrow \tilde{f}_\gamma & \\ Q\mathbb{C}\mathbb{P}^\infty & & \end{array} \quad \xrightarrow{BGL_1(\iota_R) \circ J_C \circ \varphi_n} BGL_1(R)$$

and the null-homotopy of $BGL_1(\iota_R) \circ J_C \circ \phi_n \circ f_\gamma$ to a null-homotopy of

$$BGL_1(\iota_R) \circ J_C \circ \phi_n \circ \tilde{f}_\gamma: Q\mathbb{C}\mathbb{P}^\infty \rightarrow BGL_1(R).$$

By [Seg73, Proposition 2.1] there exists a map $\alpha: BU \rightarrow Q\mathbb{C}\mathbb{P}^\infty$ such that $\tilde{f}_\gamma \circ \alpha \simeq \mathbb{1}_{BU}$. Therefore,

$$BGL_1(\iota_R) \circ J_C \circ \phi_n \simeq BGL_1(\iota_R) \circ J_C \circ \phi_n \circ \tilde{f}_\gamma \circ \alpha \simeq *.$$

We let $u_n: MU[n] \rightarrow R$ to be the corresponding R -Thom class. $\square$

Remark 2.16. Theorem 2.15 restricted to $n = 1$ is significantly weaker when compared to Quillen's result (see [Rav86, Lemma 4.1.13]). Quillen only requires that the ring R to be homotopy commutative and he proves that the R -Thom class u_1 is multiplicative. Quillen's argument when $n = 1$ relies on the computation of $R^*(BU(d)_+)$ in terms of Chern classes to gain control over the multiplicative structure. It is unclear how to generalize such direct methods to $n > 1$.

Remark 2.17. If $f_\xi: X \rightarrow BU$ is the classifying map of a virtual complex vector bundle ξ , then $\varphi_n \circ f_\xi$ classifies the bundle $n\xi$.

Lemma 2.18 (The splitting principle). *If R is an $\mathbb{E}_\infty$ -ring spectrum then $\Theta(R, \xi)$ divides $\Theta(R, \gamma)$ for any virtual complex vector bundle ξ .*

Proof. Without loss of generality, we may assume $\dim \xi = 0$. By [Remark 2.17](#), the classifying map of $\xi^{\oplus n}$ factors through φ_n

$$f_{n\xi}: B_{\xi+} \xrightarrow{f_\xi} BU \xrightarrow{\varphi_n} BU.$$

In the proof of [Theorem 2.15](#), we show that if $n\gamma$ is R -orientable then the composite

$$BU \xrightarrow{BGL_1(\iota_R) \circ J_{\mathbb{C}} \circ \varphi_n} BGL_1(R)$$

is null-homotopic. Therefore the composite $BGL_1(\iota_R) \circ J_{\mathbb{C}} \circ f_{n\xi}$ is null as well

$$BGL_1(\iota_R) \circ J_{\mathbb{C}} \circ f_{n\xi} = (BGL_1(\iota_R) \circ J_{\mathbb{C}} \circ \varphi_n) \circ f_\xi \simeq (*) \circ f_\xi \simeq *.$$

Thus, when $\Theta(R, \gamma) = n$ then $n\xi$ is R -orientable, and therefore, $\Theta(R, \xi)$ divides n . $\square$

3. The C_p -action on the Morava K-theory of $\mathbb{CP}^\infty$

Let Γ be a formal group of height $n = (p-1)k$ for some positive k such that C_p is a subgroup of $\text{Aut}(\Gamma)$ (see [Remark 1.4](#)). The goal of this section is to study the action of C_p on $K_\Gamma^* \mathbb{CP}^\infty$, where $K_\Gamma = E_\Gamma/\mathfrak{m}$ is the associated Morava K-theory. We do so by relating the action of C_p with the action of an element P_k of the Steenrod algebra on the homology of $\mathbb{CP}^\infty$ (see [\(3.17\)](#)).

The ring spectrum $EO_\Gamma := E_\Gamma^{hC_p}$ depends not only on the formal group Γ but also on the choice of embedding $\iota: C_p \hookrightarrow \text{Aut}(\Gamma)$ up to a conjugation. We emphasize that our results apply to all choices of EO_Γ because [Lemma 3.6](#) holds for all pairs (Γ, ι) . We begin by recalling some facts from Lubin-Tate theory needed in this paper.

Let $\widetilde{\mathbb{F}}$ denote the separable closure of $\mathbb{F}$ and let $\widetilde{\Gamma}$ be the base change of Γ to $\widetilde{\mathbb{F}}$. The endomorphism ring of $\widetilde{\Gamma}$ is a noncommutative valuation ring which can be explicitly described as

$$(3.1) \quad \text{End}(\widetilde{\Gamma}) \cong \mathbb{W}(\widetilde{\mathbb{F}})\langle T \rangle / (Ta - \phi(a)T, T^n - pu),$$

where T is a uniformizer, ϕ is the Frobenius and $u \in \mathbb{W}(\mathbb{F}_{p^n})^\times$ is a unit (see [\[LT66\]](#)). Note that $v(T^n) = v(pu) = 1$. Any element $e \in \text{End}(\widetilde{\Gamma})$ can be expressed as

$$(3.2) \quad e = \sum_{i=0}^{\infty} a_i T^i$$

where a_i are Teichmüller lifts of $\widetilde{\mathbb{F}}$ in $\mathbb{W}(\widetilde{\mathbb{F}})$ and the valuation is $v(e) = j/n$, where j is the smallest integer such that $a_j \neq 0$.

Notation 3.3. We will use the following notations and conventions for the remainder of the paper.

- Fix a prime p and a positive integer k . Let $n = k(p - 1)$.
- Fix a perfect field $\mathbb{F}$ of characteristic p and a formal group Γ of height n over $\mathbb{F}$ such that C_p is a subgroup of $\text{Aut}(\Gamma)$. Let E_Γ denote the associated Lubin-Tate theory. By Lubin-Tate theory [LT66]

$$\pi_* E_\Gamma \cong \mathbb{W}(\mathbb{F})[[u_1, \dots, u_{n-1}]] [u^\pm],$$

where $\mathbb{W}(\mathbb{F})$ is the ring of Witt vectors over $\mathbb{F}$. The elements $u_1, \dots, u_{n-1}$ are elements of $\pi_0 E_\Gamma$ and $u \in \pi_{-2} E_\Gamma$.

- Let $\mathfrak{m}$ denote the maximal ideal $(p, u_1, \dots, u_{n-1})$ of $\pi_* E_\Gamma$ and let K_Γ denote the corresponding height n Morava K-theory so that $\pi_* K_\Gamma \simeq \pi_*(E_\Gamma)/\mathfrak{m}$.
- Fix an embedding $\iota: C_p \rightarrow \text{Aut}(\Gamma)$ and let $\text{EO}_\Gamma := E_\Gamma^{\text{h}C_p}$.
- Abbreviate E_Γ by E , K_Γ by K , and EO_Γ by EO , leaving the dependence on Γ and ι implicit.
- Let $E_*^\wedge(-) := \pi_*(L_K(E \wedge -))$, $E_*^{\text{EO}}(-) := \pi_*(E \wedge_{\text{EO}} -)$, and $K_*^{\text{EO}}(-) = \pi_*(K \wedge_{\text{EO}} -)$.
- Fix a p -typical coordinate on Γ and let $\pi_E: \text{BP} \rightarrow E$ be the associated map. Let $\pi_K: \text{BP} \rightarrow K$ denote the composite of π_E with the reduction map from $E \rightarrow K$.
- Let $\pi_{\mathbb{F}_p}: \text{BP} \rightarrow \text{HF}_p$ be the standard reduction map.

The map $\pi_E: \text{BP} \rightarrow E$ induces a map $\text{BP} \wedge \text{BP} \rightarrow E \wedge E \rightarrow L_K(E \wedge E)$. There is a homotopy coequalizer map $L_K(E \wedge E) \rightarrow E \wedge_{\text{EO}} E$. These maps fit into a diagram

$$(3.4) \quad \begin{array}{ccccc} \text{BP}_* \text{BP} & \xrightarrow{\rho_E} & E_*^\wedge E & \xrightarrow{\quad} & E_*^{\text{EO}} E \\ & & \parallel & & \parallel \\ & & \text{Maps}^{\text{cts}}(\text{Aut}(\Gamma), E_*) & \xrightarrow{\text{Res}^{C_p}} & \text{Map}(C_p, E_*) \end{array}$$

The vertical isomorphisms are by Galois theory [Rog08, Theorem 5.4.4 and Definition 4.1.3]. The map Res^{C_p} is restriction along the inclusion map $\iota: C_p \rightarrow \text{Aut}(\Gamma)$.

Notation 3.5. Given $\theta \in \text{BP}_* \text{BP}$ and $\mathbf{g} \in \text{Aut}(\Gamma)$, the map

$$\rho_E: \text{BP}_* \text{BP} \longrightarrow E_*^\wedge E = \text{Map}^c(\text{Aut}(\Gamma), E_*)$$

allows us to interpret the element $\theta(\mathbf{g}) := \rho_E(\theta)(\mathbf{g}) \in E_*$. Let $\bar{\theta}(\mathbf{g})$ denote the image of $\theta(\mathbf{g})$ under the quotient map

$$E_* \rightarrow E_*/\mathfrak{m} \cong K_*.$$

There is an isomorphism $\text{BP}_* \text{BP} \cong \text{BP}_*[t_1, t_2, \dots]$.

Lemma 3.6. *Let $\zeta \in \text{Aut}(\Gamma)$ be an element of order p . Then $\bar{t}_i(\zeta) = 0$ for $i < k$ and $\bar{t}_k(\zeta)$ is a unit.*

Proof. Let $\widetilde{\mathbb{F}}$ be the separable closure of $\mathbb{F}$, $\widetilde{\Gamma}$ be the base change of Γ to $\widetilde{\mathbb{F}}$ and $\widetilde{K} := K_{\widetilde{\Gamma}}$ be the Morava K-theory associated to $\widetilde{\Gamma}$. The field extension $\mathbb{F} \rightarrow \widetilde{\mathbb{F}}$ induces the inclusion of groups

$$\alpha: \text{Aut}(\Gamma) \hookrightarrow \text{Aut}(\widetilde{\Gamma})$$

as well as a map

$$f: K_* \longrightarrow \widetilde{K}_*$$

on Morava K-theories. Since f is an injection and

$$\bar{t}_i(\alpha(\zeta)) = f(\bar{t}_i(\zeta)),$$

it suffices show that $\bar{t}_i(\tilde{\zeta}) = 0$ for $i < k$ and $\bar{t}_k(\tilde{\zeta})$ is a unit whenever $\tilde{\zeta} \in \text{Aut}(\widetilde{\Gamma})$ is an element of order p . When expressed as a power series (as in (3.2))

$$\tilde{\zeta} = 1 + \sum_{i>0} a_i T^i,$$

and it follows from the properties of t_i that

$$(3.7) \quad t_i(\tilde{\zeta}) \equiv a_i u^{1-p^i} \pmod{\mathfrak{m}}$$

(see [BE20, 2-6] or [Rav78][pg. 437]). Because $\mathbb{Q}_p(\tilde{\zeta})$ is a totally ramified extension of $\mathbb{Q}_p$ of degree $p-1$ with $\tilde{\zeta}-1$ as a uniformizer,

$$v(\tilde{\zeta}-1) = \frac{1}{p-1} = v(T^k).$$

Thus, $a_i = 0$ if $i < k$ in (3.7) and a unit if $i = k$. □

3.1. Filtering the C_p -action on K_*X

For any spectrum X the $E_*^{\text{EO}}E$ -coaction on E_*X , given by the composition

$$(3.8) \quad \Psi: E_*X \xrightarrow{\Psi_E} E_*^{\wedge} E \otimes_{E_*} E_*X \xrightarrow{\text{Res}^{C_p} \otimes \text{id}} E_*^{\text{EO}} E \otimes_{E_*} E_*X,$$

leads to a contragradient action of C_p as $E_*^{\text{EO}} E \cong \text{Map}(C_p, E_*)$. Explicitly, the action of $g \in C_p$ is given by the map

$$(3.9) \quad E_*X \xrightarrow{\Psi} E_*^{\text{EO}} E \otimes_{E_*} E_*X \xrightarrow{\text{ev}_g \otimes 1} E_*X.$$

Note that $E_*^{\text{EO}} E \cong \text{Map}(C_p, E_*)$ is a quotient Hopf algebra of $E_*^{\wedge} E$ and dual to the Hopf algebra $\pi_*(\text{EO-Mod}(E, E)) \cong E_*[C_p]^\sigma$ as defined in Remark 3.10.

Remark 3.10. The nontrivial action of C_p on E_* means $\pi_*(\text{EO-Mod}(E, E))$ is isomorphic as a ring to the *twisted* group ring

$$E_*[C_p]^\sigma := E_*\langle \zeta \rangle / (\zeta^p = 1, \zeta \cdot e = \zeta(e) \cdot \zeta),$$

where $e \in E_*$. Since the action of C_p on K_* is trivial, $E_*[C_p]^\sigma / \mathfrak{m}$ is isomorphic to the untwisted group ring $K_*[C_p]$.

Definition 3.11. A spectrum X is even if X is bounded below, $H\mathbb{Z}_{2i+1}X = 0$ and $H\mathbb{Z}_{2i}X$ is a finitely generated $\mathbb{Z}$ -module for all integers i .

When X is an even spectrum, there is an isomorphism

$$K_*X \cong E_*X/\mathfrak{m}$$

which makes K_*X into a $K_*[C_p]$ -module.

Next, we use the Atiyah-Hirzebruch filtration to relate the $K_*[C_p]$ -module structure on K_*X to the $\mathcal{B}(k)_*$ comodule structure on H_*X for an even spectrum X , where $\mathcal{B}(k)_*$ is a quotient Hopf algebra of the even dual Steenrod algebra. The Atiyah-Hirzebruch filtration on R_*X is an increasing filtration induced by the skeletal filtration of X

$$\text{Fil}_d R_*X := R_*X^{(d)} \subseteq R_*X.$$

The associated graded

$$\text{gr } R_*X := \bigoplus \frac{\text{Fil}_d R_*X}{\text{Fil}_{d-1} R_*X}$$

is bigraded as the second grading is induced by the internal grading of R_*X .

When R is complex orientable (e.g. BP, K and E) and X is an even spectrum (e.g. $\mathbb{CP}_n^{n+k}$), the AHSS (Atiyah Hirzebruch spectral sequence) for R_*X collapses on the E_2 -page. This collapse induces an isomorphism

$$\text{gr } R_*X \cong R_* \otimes H_*X.$$

Lemma 3.12. *Let X be an even spectrum and let $\chi = \zeta - 1 \in K_*[C_p]$. Then*

$$\chi_* \text{Fil}_d K_*X \subseteq \text{Fil}_{d-2p^k+2} K_*X.$$

Proof. We required that X be even so the map $K_* \otimes_{BP_*} BP_*X \rightarrow K_*X$ is surjective and we can check our claim on the image.

Pick $x^{\text{BP}} \in \text{Fil}_d BP_*X$. Write $x^K = \pi_{K*}(x^{\text{BP}})$ and $x^{\mathbb{F}_p} = \pi_{\mathbb{F}_p*}(x^{\text{BP}})$. Write the BP-coaction on x^{BP} as

$$\Psi(x^{\text{BP}}) = 1 \otimes x^{\text{BP}} + \sum \theta_{(1)} \otimes x_{(2)}^{\text{BP}}.$$

The counit axiom says that

$$(\epsilon \otimes 1)(\Psi(x^{\text{BP}})) = x^{\text{BP}} = (\epsilon \otimes 1)(1 \otimes x^{\text{BP}})$$

so we may assume that $\theta_{(1)} \in \ker \epsilon = (t_1, t_2, \dots)$. By definition,

$$\chi_*(x^K) = (\zeta - 1)_*(x^K) = \sum \bar{\theta}_{(1)}(\zeta) \cdot x_{(2)}^K$$

where $\bar{\theta}_{(1)}$ is as in [Notation 3.5](#). By [Lemma 3.6](#), $\bar{\theta}_{(1)}(\zeta) = 0$ when

$$\bar{\theta}_{(1)} \in (t_1, \dots, t_{k-1}) \subseteq BP_*BP,$$

therefore $\chi_*(x^K) \in \text{Fil}_{d-|t_k|} K_*X = \text{Fil}_{d-2p^k+2} K_*X$ as t_k is the element of lowest degree in $\ker \epsilon / (t_1, \dots, t_{k-1})$. $\square$

We introduce an increasing filtration on $K_*[C_p]$ by assigning χ an ‘Atiyah Hirzebruch weight’

$$|\chi|_{\text{AH}} = -|t_k| = 2 - 2p^k.$$

We denote the associated graded by $\text{gr } K_*[C_p]$ and the representative of χ in $\text{gr } K_*[C_p]$ by $\bar{\chi}$. It follows from [Lemma 3.12](#) that, for an even spectrum X , the $K_*[C_p]$ -module structure on K_*X induces a $\text{gr } K_*[C_p]$ -module structure on $\text{gr } K_*X$ (see [Lemma 3.16](#)).

Lemma 3.13. *The bigraded Hopf algebra $\text{gr } K_*[C_p]$ is isomorphic to*

$$K_*[\bar{\chi}]/(\bar{\chi}^p),$$

where $\bar{\chi}$ is a primitive in the Atiyah Hirzebruch filtration $2 - 2p^k$.

Proof. Since $\Delta(\zeta) = \zeta \otimes \zeta$ and $\chi = \zeta - 1$, we see $\Delta(\chi) = \chi \otimes 1 + 1 \otimes \chi + \chi \otimes \chi$. Thus, in the associated graded $\Delta(\bar{\chi}) = \bar{\chi} \otimes 1 + 1 \otimes \bar{\chi}$. $\square$

Let $\mathcal{P}$ be the quotient Hopf algebra of the Steenrod algebra

$$\mathcal{P} = \mathcal{A} // (Q_0, Q_1, \dots)$$

where Q_i are the Milnor primitives. Its dual is the sub Hopf algebra of $\mathcal{A}_*$ generated by the even degree generators

$$\mathcal{P}_* \cong \begin{cases} \mathbb{F}_p[\xi_1, \xi_2, \dots] \subset \mathcal{A}_* & \text{if } p \text{ is odd} \\ \mathbb{F}_p[\xi_1^2, \xi_2^2, \dots] \subset \mathcal{A}_* & \text{if } p = 2. \end{cases}$$

Under the map $(\pi_{\mathbb{F}_p} \wedge \pi_{\mathbb{F}_p})_* : \text{BP}_* \text{BP} \rightarrow \mathcal{A}_*$ the image of t_k is

$$(\pi_{\mathbb{F}_p} \wedge \pi_{\mathbb{F}_p})_*(t_k) = \begin{cases} c(\xi_k) & \text{if } p \text{ is odd} \\ c(\xi_k^2) & \text{if } p = 2, \end{cases}$$

where c denotes the antipode map of the dual Steenrod algebra. It follows from the definition of $\xi_k \in \mathcal{P}_*$ that its linear dual $P_k \in \mathcal{P}$ satisfies the formula

$$(3.14) \quad P_k(x) = x^{p^k}$$

where $x \in H^2\mathbb{CP}_+^\infty$ is a generator (see [Mil58]).

Definition 3.15. Let $\mathcal{B}(k) \subset \mathcal{P}$ denote the sub Hopf algebra generated by P_k . As a Hopf algebra

$$\mathcal{B}(k) \cong \mathbb{F}_p[P_k]/(P_k^p)$$

where P_k is a primitive.

Note that $c(\xi_k) \equiv -\xi_k \pmod{(\xi_1, \dots, \xi_{k-1})}$, which leads to the negative sign in [Lemma 3.16](#). Let

$$\iota_X : H_*X \longrightarrow \text{gr } K_*X \cong K_* \otimes H_*X$$

be the map that sends $x \mapsto 1 \otimes x$.

Lemma 3.16. *For an even spectrum X*

$$(3.17) \quad \bar{\chi}(\iota_X(x)) = -\bar{t}_k(\zeta)\iota_X(P_k(x))$$

for all $x \in H_*X$.

Proof. Let p be an odd prime. Let $x^{\mathbb{F}_p} = x$ and $y^{\mathbb{F}_p} = y = P_k(x)$, $\mathcal{I}_r^{\mathbb{F}_p} = \mathcal{P}_* \otimes \text{Fil}_r H_*X$ and $\mathcal{I}_r^{\text{BP}} = \text{BP}_* \text{BP} \otimes_{\text{BP}_*} \text{Fil}_r \text{BP}_*X$. The $\mathcal{A}_*$ coaction on $x^{\mathbb{F}_p}$ is

$$\Psi(x^{\mathbb{F}_p}) \equiv 1 \otimes x^{\mathbb{F}_p} + \xi_k \otimes y^{\mathbb{F}_p} \pmod{(\xi_1, \dots, \xi_{k-1}, \mathcal{I}_{d-2p^k}^{\mathbb{F}_p})}.$$

Let x^{BP} be a lift of x to BP_dX . It follows that the BP coaction on x^{BP} is

$$\Psi(x^{\text{BP}}) \equiv 1 \otimes x^{\text{BP}} - t_k \otimes y^{\text{BP}} \pmod{(p, \dots, v_{n-1}, t_1, \dots, t_{k-1}, \mathcal{I}_{d-2p^k}^{\text{BP}})},$$

where y^{BP} is a lift of $y^{\mathbb{F}_p}$. Since $\bar{\theta}(\zeta) \equiv 0 \pmod{\mathfrak{m}}$ for $\bar{\theta} \in (t_1, \dots, t_{k-1})$, we get

$$\zeta \cdot x^K \equiv x^K - \bar{t}_k(\zeta)y^K \pmod{\text{Fil}_{d-2p^k} K_*X}.$$

Since $\iota_X(x) = [\pi_{K*}(x^{\text{BP}})]$ and $\iota_X(P_k(x)) = [\pi_{K*}(y^{\text{BP}})]$, the result follows.

The same argument works for $p = 2$ after replacing ξ_i with ξ_i^2 above. $\square$

Remark 3.18. Following Lemma 3.13 and Lemma 3.16, we see that there is a Hopf algebra isomorphism

$$K_* \otimes \mathcal{B}(k) \cong \text{gr } K_*[C_p]$$

obtained by sending $P_k \mapsto -\bar{t}_k(\zeta)\bar{\chi}$. This isomorphism relates the $K_* \otimes \mathcal{B}(k)$ -module structure on the left to the $\text{gr } K_*[C_p]$ -module structure on the right, of the isomorphism

$$K_* \otimes H_*X \cong \text{gr } K_*X$$

for any even spectrum X .

3.2. The action of C_p on $K_*\mathbb{CP}_+^\infty$

We now explicitly compute the coaction of $\mathcal{B}(k)$ on $H_*\mathbb{CP}_+^\infty$ and deduce that $K_*\mathbb{CP}_+^\infty$ has a large $K_*[C_p]$ -free summand.

Notation 3.19. Let x be the generator of $H^*\mathbb{CP}_+^\infty \cong \mathbb{F}_p[[x]]$ and let $b_i \in H_{2i}\mathbb{CP}_+^\infty$ be the linear dual of x^i . The HF_p -Thom isomorphism for $c\gamma$ implies $H^*\mathbb{CP}_c^\infty$ is a free module of rank one over $H^*\mathbb{CP}_+^\infty$. Fix an HF_p -Thom class $u_c \in H^{2c}\mathbb{CP}_c^\infty$. Let

$$b_i \in H_{2i}\mathbb{CP}_c^\infty$$

denote the linear dual to $x^{i-n} \cdot u_c$. We also use $b_i \in H_{2i}\mathbb{CP}_c^{a+c}$ to denote the element which maps to b_i under the skeletal inclusion $\mathbb{CP}_c^{a+c} \rightarrow \mathbb{CP}_c^\infty$.

Notation 3.20. Let $\beta_k := \frac{|P_k^{p-1}|}{2} = (p-1)(p^k-1)$.

Proposition 3.21. *Let c be an integer. The action of $\bar{\chi}$ on*

$$\text{gr } K_*\mathbb{CP}_c^\infty \cong K_*\{b_c, b_{c-1}, \dots\}$$

is given by

$$\bar{\chi}_*(b_i) = \begin{cases} (i - p^k + 1)b_{i-p^k+1} & \text{if } i \geq p^k - 1 + c \\ 0 & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

Moreover, there is a $\text{gr } K_[C_p]$ -module isomorphism*

$$\text{gr } K_*\mathbb{CP}_c^\infty \cong F_c^{\text{gr } K} \oplus M_c^{\text{gr } K}$$

where $\text{gr } F_c$ is a free $\text{gr } K_[C_p]$ -module of infinite rank and $\text{gr } M_c$ is a finite dimensional K_* -module.*

Remark 3.22. The Hopf algebras $K_*[C_p]$ and $\text{gr } K_*[C_p]$ are self injective. In other words, if M is a $K_*[C_p]$ -module and

$$i: K_*[C_p]\{\iota\} \rightarrow M$$

is an injective map then i admits a splitting (and similarly for $\text{gr } K_*[C_p]$ -modules).

Proof. By Lemma 3.16, it suffices to compute the action of $\mathcal{B}(k)$ on $H_*\mathbb{CP}_c^\infty$. Since $P_k \in \mathcal{P}$ is primitive (see Remark 3.23), its action on $H^*\mathbb{CP}^\infty \cong \mathbb{F}_p[[x]]$ follows the Leibniz rule

$$P_k(x^i) = ix^{i-1}P_k(x).$$

The action of P_k on $H^*\mathbb{CP}_c^\infty \cong \mathbb{F}_p[[x]] \cdot u_c$ can be calculated using the formula

$$P_k(x^i \cdot u_c) = P_k(x^i) \cdot u_c + x^i \cdot P_k(u_c).$$

By (3.14), $P_k(x) = x^{p^k}$ and $P_k(u_c) = cx^{p^k-1} \cdot u_c$. Therefore,

$$P_k(x^i \cdot u_c) = (i + c)x^{i+p^k-1} \cdot u_c.$$

Dually

$$P_k(b_i) = (i - p^k + 1)b_{i-p^k+1},$$

where it is understood that $P_k(b_i) = 0$ if $i - p^k + 1 < c$. Thus, $\text{gr } K_*\mathbb{CP}_c^\infty$ contains an infinite rank free $\text{gr } K_*[C_p]$ -submodule $F_c^{\text{gr } K}$ generated by the set

$$\{b_{pi} : i > (\beta_k - c)/p\}.$$

By Remark 3.22, $F_c^{\text{gr } K}$ is a summand of $\text{gr } K_*\mathbb{CP}_c^\infty$. We denote its complement by $M_c^{\text{gr } K}$. $\square$

Remark 3.23. If $p = 2$, then $\Delta(P_k) = P_k \otimes 1 + Q_k \otimes Q_k + 1 \otimes P_k$ in $\mathcal{A}$ but the quotient map $\mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathcal{P}$ sends $Q_k \mapsto 0$ and so we see that P_k is primitive as an element of $\mathcal{P}$ even though it is not a primitive element of $\mathcal{A}$. If p is odd, P_k is primitive even in $\mathcal{A}$.

Lemma 3.24. *Let M be a $K_*[C_p]$ -module which admits an increasing filtration*

$$\{0\} = \text{Fil}_{-c} M \subset \cdots \subset \text{Fil}_0 M \subset \text{Fil}_1 M \subset \cdots \subset M$$

so that $M = \text{colim}_i \text{Fil}_i M$. Suppose that the action of $K_[C_p]$ on M satisfies*

$$\chi \text{Fil}_k M \subset \text{Fil}_{k-2p^k+2} M$$

so that $\text{gr } M$ is a $\text{gr } K_[C_p]$ -module. Also, suppose there is an injective $\text{gr } K_*[C_p]$ -module map*

$$\tilde{\alpha}: \tilde{F} \longrightarrow \text{gr } M,$$

where $\tilde{F}$ is a free $\text{gr } K_[C_p]$ -module. Then there exists a lift of $\tilde{\alpha}$ to an injective $K_*[C_p]$ -module map*

$$\alpha: F \longrightarrow M,$$

where F is a free $K_[C_p]$ -module. In fact, α is the inclusion of a summand.*

Proof. Let us choose a basis so that we may write

$$\tilde{F} = \bigoplus_{i \in I} \text{gr } K_*[C_p] \{\tilde{\iota}_i\} \text{ and } F = \bigoplus_{i \in I} K_*[C_p] \{\iota_i\}.$$

By assumption, any element $m_i \in M$ such that $[m_i] = \tilde{\alpha}(\tilde{\iota}_i)$ satisfies

$$\bar{\chi}^i[m_i] = [\chi^i(m_i)].$$

Fix such an m_i for each $i > -c$. Now define the map α by setting $\alpha(\iota_i) = m_i$ and extending it linearly to a $K_*[C_p]$ -module map. Clearly α is injective as $\tilde{\alpha}$ is injective, and it splits as $K_*[C_p]$ is self-injective (see Remark 3.22). $\square$

Proposition 3.21 and Lemma 3.24 imply:

Corollary 3.25. *For any $c \in \mathbb{Z}$, there exists a $K_*[C_p]$ -module isomorphism*

$$K_*\mathbb{CP}_c^\infty \cong F_c^K \oplus M_c^K,$$

where F_c^K is free and M_c^K is finitely generated as $K_[C_p]$ -modules.*

4. An upper bound on the EO-orientation order of γ

In [Section 4.1](#), we lift the $K_*[C_p]$ -module splitting of [Corollary 3.25](#) to an EO-module splitting (see [Corollary 4.19](#)). In [Section 4.2](#) we show that the inclusion of the compact summand of $EO \wedge \mathbb{CP}_c^\infty$ factors through $EO \wedge \mathbb{CP}_c^{c+d}$, where $d = p^k(p-1) - 1$. This leads to the proof of [Main Theorem 1.5](#). In [Section 4.3](#), we prove [Main Theorem 1.8](#).

4.1. A splitting of $EO \wedge \mathbb{CP}_c^\infty$

Now we extend the ‘free $\oplus$ finite’ decomposition of $K_*[C_p]$ -modules in [Corollary 3.25](#) to a ‘free $\oplus$ finite’ decomposition of $E_*[C_p]^\sigma$ -comodules (see [Corollary 4.4](#)) using the fact that a free $E_*[C_p]^\sigma$ -module is injective relative to E_* (see [Proposition 4.2](#)).

Definition 4.1 ([\[Hoc56\]](#)). Let S be a subring of a commutative ring R . An R -module M is (R, S) -*injective* (injective relative to S) if every R -module injection $M \hookrightarrow N$ that splits in the category of S -modules also splits in the category of R -modules.

Proposition 4.2. *A free $E_*[C_p]^\sigma$ -module F is $(E_*[C_p]^\sigma, E_*)$ -injective.*

Proof. Hochschild [\[Hoc56, Lemma 1\]](#) showed that $\text{Hom}_S(R, A)$ is (R, S) -injective when S is a subring of R and A is an S -module. Since

$$E_*[C_p]^\sigma \cong \text{Hom}_{E_*}(E_*[C_p]^\sigma, E_*)$$

as a $E_*[C_p]^\sigma$ -module, the result follows. $\square$

Lemma 4.3. *Suppose Q^E is a free $E_*[C_p]^\sigma$ -module whose underlying E_* -module is free and there is a $K_*[C_p]$ -module splitting*

$$Q^E/\mathfrak{m} \cong F^K \oplus M^K$$

where F^K is free and M^K is finitely generated. Then there is an $E_[C_p]^\sigma$ -module splitting*

$$Q^E \cong F^E \oplus M^E,$$

where F^E is free and M^E is finitely generated.

Proof. Let F^E be a free $E_*[C_p]^\sigma$ -module such that $F^E/\mathfrak{m} \cong F^K$. Fix an $E_*[C_p]^\sigma$ -basis $\mathcal{B} = \{b_i : i \in \mathbb{N}\}$ of F^E . Let

$$\iota_K : F^K \xrightarrow{\quad} Q^E/\mathfrak{m} : \pi_K$$

denote the $K_*[C_p]$ -maps that split F^K from $Q^E/\mathfrak{m}$. We will now show that the maps ι_K and π_K can be lifted to $E_*[C_p]^\sigma$ -module maps ι_E and π_E

$$\begin{array}{ccc} F^E & \xrightarrow{\quad \iota_E \quad} & Q^E \\ \pi_1 \downarrow & \swarrow \pi_E & \downarrow \pi_2 \\ F^K & \xrightarrow{\quad \iota_K \quad} & Q^E/\mathfrak{m} \end{array}$$

such that $\pi_E \circ \iota_E$ is the identity.

The $E_*[C_p]^\sigma$ -linear map ι_E can be defined by sending b_i to an arbitrary lift of $\iota_K(\pi_1(b_i))$. Since E_* is Noetherian, F^E and Q^E are both E_* -free and ι_K is injective, we conclude that ι_E is also injective (essentially from the Krull intersection theorem). The freeness of F^E and Q^E as E_* -modules also implies the existence of an E_* -linear map π_E such that $\pi_E \circ \iota_E$ is the identity. By [Proposition 4.2](#), π_E can be chosen so that it is $E_*[C_p]^\sigma$ -linear. $\square$

Corollary 4.4. *For any $c \in \mathbb{Z}$, there exists an $E_*[C_p]^\sigma$ -module isomorphism*

$$E_*\mathbb{CP}_c^\infty \cong F_c^E \oplus M_c^E,$$

where F_c^E is free and M_c^E is finitely generated as $E_*[C_p]^\sigma$ -modules.

Next, we use the relative Adams spectral sequence for the map $EO \rightarrow E$ to show that the algebraic splitting of [Corollary 4.4](#) originates from an EO -module splitting of $EO \wedge \mathbb{CP}_c^\infty$.

Definition 4.5. An EO -module $\mathcal{X}$ is *relatively projective* (resp. *relatively free*) if $E_*^{EO}\mathcal{X}$ is a projective (resp. free) E_* -module.

Example 4.6. The spectrum E is a relatively free EO -module.

Example 4.7. When X is an even spectrum $EO \wedge X$ is a relatively free EO -module.

Theorem 4.8 ([\[Dev05, Corollary 3.4\]](#)). *Suppose that $\mathcal{X}$ and $\mathcal{Y}$ are EO -modules such that $\mathcal{X}$ is finite and relatively projective. The Adams spectral sequence relative to the map $EO \rightarrow E$*

$$(4.9) \quad E_2^{s,t} := \text{Ext}_{E_*^{EO}E}^{s,t}(E_*^{EO}\mathcal{X}, E_*^{EO}\mathcal{Y}) \Rightarrow \pi_{t-s} EO\text{-Mod}(\mathcal{X}, \mathcal{Y}),$$

is strongly convergent.

The relative Adams spectral sequence was developed by Baker and Lazarev [\[BL01\]](#). Devinatz [\[Dev05\]](#) defined the homotopy fixed points E^{hG} for G an arbitrary closed subgroup of $\text{Aut}(\Gamma)$. He identified the E_2 -page of the relative Adams spectral sequence for $E^{hG} \rightarrow E$ with the group cohomology of G and showed that for every E^{hG} -module the relative Adams spectral sequence is strongly convergent and that there is a uniform horizontal vanishing line independent of the E^{hG} -module. Rognes [\[Rog08\]](#) developed the theory of Galois extensions of ring spectra and reinterpreted the results of Devinatz by concluding that the map $EO \rightarrow E$ is Galois (see [\[Rog08, Theorem 5.4.4\]](#)). Let

$$D_{EO}(-) := EO\text{-Mod}(-, EO): EO\text{-module} \rightarrow EO\text{-module}$$

denote the relative Spanier-Whitehead dual functor.

Proposition 4.10. [\[Rog08, Proposition 6.4.7\]](#) $D_{EO}(E) \simeq E$.

Lemma 4.11. *The edge homomorphism for the relative Adams spectral sequence*

$$(4.12) \quad \pi_* EO\text{-Mod}(\mathcal{X}, \mathcal{Y}) \longrightarrow \text{Hom}_{E_*^{EO}E}(E_*^{EO}\mathcal{X}, E_*^{EO}\mathcal{Y})$$

is an isomorphism if

- (I) $\mathcal{Y} = E$ and $\mathcal{X}$ is a finite relatively-projective EO -module, or if
- (II) $\mathcal{X} = E$ and $\mathcal{Y}$ is an arbitrary EO -module.

Proof. When $\mathcal{Y} = E$ and $\mathcal{X}$ is finite, the edge map (4.12) is an isomorphism, as $E_*^{EO}E$ is a cofree $E_*^{EO}E$ -comodule and the spectral sequence (4.9) is concentrated in the zero line.

When $\mathcal{X} = E$ is a finite self-dual EO-module (see Proposition 4.10) and therefore,

$$\mathcal{X} \wedge_{EO} \mathcal{Y} \simeq D_{EO}(\mathcal{X}) \wedge_{EO} \mathcal{Y} \simeq EO\text{-Mod}(\mathcal{X}, \mathcal{Y}).$$

Since $E_*^{EO}E$ is E_* -free, we have a Kunneth isomorphism

$$E_*^{EO}(D_{EO}(E) \wedge_{EO} \mathcal{Y}) \cong E_*^{EO}(E \wedge_{EO} \mathcal{Y}) \cong E_*^{EO}(E) \otimes_{E_*} E_*^{EO}\mathcal{Y}$$

and consequently $E_*^{EO}(D_{EO}(E) \wedge_{EO} \mathcal{Y})$ is cofree as an $E_*^{EO}E$ -comodule. Therefore, the spectral sequence (4.9) is concentrated on the zero line and the edge homomorphism (4.12) is an equivalence as desired. $\square$

As a consequence of the convergence of the relative Adams spectral sequence, we deduce that $K_*^{EO}(-)$ detects equivalences of EO-modules:

Corollary 4.13. *Suppose that $\mathcal{X}$ and $\mathcal{Y}$ are relatively projective EO-modules. An EO-module map*

$$f: \mathcal{X} \longrightarrow \mathcal{Y}$$

is a weak equivalence if and only if

$$f_*: K_*^{EO}\mathcal{X} \xrightarrow{\cong} K_*^{EO}\mathcal{Y}$$

is a K_ -isomorphism.*

Proof. By the Nakayama lemma, if $f_*: K_*^{EO}\mathcal{X} \rightarrow K_*^{EO}\mathcal{Y}$ is an isomorphism, then so is $f_*: E_*^{EO}\mathcal{X} \rightarrow E_*^{EO}\mathcal{Y}$. Thus f induces an isomorphism of relative Adams E_2 -pages. It follows that f induces an isomorphism on π_* . The converse is obvious. $\square$

Definition 4.14. We say an EO-module $\mathcal{X}$ is *freely filtered* if there is a filtration

$$\mathcal{X}^{(0)} \rightarrow \mathcal{X}^{(1)} \rightarrow \dots \rightarrow \mathcal{X}$$

such that

- (1) $\mathcal{X}^{(0)}$ is contractible,
- (2) each $\mathcal{X}^{(d)}$ is a compact relatively free EO-module,
- (3) the map $\mathcal{X}^{(d)} \rightarrow \mathcal{X}^{(d+1)}$ is an EO-module map, and
- (4) $\text{colim}_d \mathcal{X}^{(d)} \simeq \mathcal{X}$.

Example 4.15. For any even spectrum X of finite type, $EO \wedge X$ is a freely filtered EO-module where the filtration is induced by the skeletal filtration of X .

Lemma 4.16. *Suppose that $\mathcal{X}$ is a freely filtered EO-module with a $K_*[C_p]$ -module splitting*

$$K_*^{EO}(\mathcal{X})/\mathfrak{m} \cong F^K \oplus M^K,$$

where F is free with countable basis. Then there exists an EO-module splitting

$$\mathcal{X} \simeq \mathcal{F} \vee \mathcal{M}$$

where $\mathcal{F}$ is a free E -module such that $K_^{EO}\mathcal{F} \cong F$ and $\mathcal{M}$ is an EO-module such that $K_*^{EO}\mathcal{M} \cong M$.*

Proof. Let us present the free $K_*[C_p]$ -module F as

$$F^K := \bigoplus_{\mathcal{B}} K_*[C_p] \cdot \mathbf{b}_i$$

using a basis $\mathcal{B} := \{\mathbf{b}_i : 0 \leq i < n \leq \infty\}$. Let $F_i^K := K_*[C_p] \cdot \mathbf{b}_i \subset F^K$. Let ι^K and π^K denote the inclusion and the projection map for the split-summand corresponding to F_0^K . Because F_0^K is a finite $K_*[C_p]$ -module, there exists a solution to the diagram of $K_*[C_p]$ -modules

$$(4.17) \quad \begin{array}{ccccc} F_0^K & \xlongequal{\quad} & F_0^K & \xlongequal{\quad} & \dots & \xlongequal{\quad} & F_0^K \\ \iota_\ell^K \downarrow \uparrow \pi_\ell^K & & \iota_{\ell+1}^K \downarrow \uparrow \pi_{\ell+1}^K & & & & \iota^K \downarrow \uparrow \pi^K \\ K_*^{\text{EO}} \mathcal{X}^{(\ell)} & \longrightarrow & K_*^{\text{EO}} \mathcal{X}^{(\ell+1)} & \longrightarrow & \dots & \longrightarrow & K_*^{\text{EO}} \mathcal{X} \end{array}$$

for some $\ell \gg 0$. Using [Lemma 4.3](#), we can extend (4.17) to a diagram of $E_*[C_p]^\sigma$ -modules (or equivalently E_*^{EO} -comodules)

$$(4.18) \quad \begin{array}{ccccc} E_*^{\text{EO}} E & \xlongequal{\quad} & E_*^{\text{EO}} E & \xlongequal{\quad} & \dots & \xlongequal{\quad} & E_*^{\text{EO}} E \\ \iota_\ell^E \downarrow \uparrow \pi_\ell^E & & \iota_{\ell+1}^E \downarrow \uparrow \pi_{\ell+1}^E & & & & \iota^E \downarrow \uparrow \pi^E \\ E_*^{\text{EO}} \mathcal{X}^{(\ell)} & \longrightarrow & E_*^{\text{EO}} \mathcal{X}^{(\ell+1)} & \longrightarrow & \dots & \longrightarrow & E_*^{\text{EO}} \mathcal{X}. \end{array}$$

By [Lemma 4.11](#), the maps ι_j^E and π_j^E can be realized in the homotopy category of EO-modules

$$\iota_j : E \xleftarrow{\quad} \mathcal{X}^{(j)} : \pi_j$$

for all $i \geq \ell$. Since $\text{colim}_i \mathcal{X}^{(i)} \simeq \mathcal{X}$, we conclude that there exists an EO-module $\mathcal{M}$ such that

$$K_*^{\text{EO}} \mathcal{M} \cong \bigoplus_{i=1}^{n-1} K_*[C_p] \cdot \mathbf{b}_i \oplus M^K$$

and an EO-module equivalence

$$\mathcal{X} \simeq E \vee \mathcal{M}.$$

Note that $\mathcal{M}$ can be filtered as

$$\mathcal{M}^{(0)} \rightarrow \mathcal{M}^{(1)} \rightarrow \dots \rightarrow \mathcal{M},$$

where $\mathcal{M}^{(i)} = \text{Cofib}(\iota_{\ell+i})$ and $E_*^{\text{EO}} \mathcal{M}^{(i)}$ is E_* -free. Thus our results follow from an inductive argument. $\square$

Combining [Corollary 3.25](#) and [Lemma 4.16](#), we get:

Corollary 4.19. *For any $c \in \mathbb{Z}$, there exists an EO-module splitting*

$$\text{EO} \wedge \mathbb{C}\mathbb{P}_c^\infty \simeq \mathcal{F}_c \vee \mathcal{M}_c,$$

where $\mathcal{F}_c \simeq \bigvee_{\mathbb{N}} E$ and $\mathcal{M}_c$ is a compact EO-module.

[Main Theorem 1.7](#) is the case $c = 0$ in [Corollary 4.19](#).

4.2. An EO-Thom isomorphism

Recall from the proof of [Proposition 3.21](#) that the summand $M_0^{\text{gr } K}$ of $\text{gr } K_* \mathbb{CP}_+^\infty$ factors through $\text{gr } K_* \mathbb{CP}_+^{\hat{\beta}_k}$, where

$$\hat{\beta}_k := p^k(p-1)$$

is the smallest multiple of p which is greater than $\beta_k = |P_k^{p-1}|/2 = (p-1)(p^k-1)$. This algebraic factorization can be leveraged to obtain the following result.

Lemma 4.20. *For all $c \in \mathbb{Z}$, the inclusion map $s'' : \mathcal{M}_{pc} \hookrightarrow \text{EO} \wedge \mathbb{CP}_{pc}^\infty$ of the splitting in [Corollary 4.19](#) can be chosen so that the inclusion of $\mathcal{M}_{pc}$ factors through $\text{EO} \wedge \mathbb{CP}_{pc}^{\hat{\beta}_k+pc}$*

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & \mathcal{M}_{pc} & \\ & \swarrow \bar{s}' \quad \downarrow s'' & \\ \text{EO} \wedge \mathbb{CP}_{pc}^{\hat{\beta}_k+pc} & \xrightarrow{\text{sk}} & \text{EO} \wedge \mathbb{CP}_{pc}^\infty \end{array}$$

in the homotopy category of EO-modules.

Proof. We present the argument for $c = 0$. The general argument follows from the $\mathcal{B}(k)$ -module isomorphism of [Lemma 4.21](#).

We start with an arbitrary splitting of $\text{EO} \wedge \mathbb{CP}_+^\infty$, where

$$\mathcal{F}_0 \xrightarrow{s} \text{EO} \wedge \mathbb{CP}_+^\infty \xrightarrow{f} \mathcal{F}_0$$

$$\mathcal{M}_0 \xrightarrow{s'} \text{EO} \wedge \mathbb{CP}_+^\infty \xrightarrow{f'} \mathcal{M}_0,$$

are the inclusion and projection maps of the components. We will modify this splitting to produce a new one which satisfies our conclusion.

The free summand F_0 of the $\mathcal{B}(k)$ -module $H_* \mathbb{CP}^\infty$ surjects onto $H_* \mathbb{CP}_{\hat{\beta}_k}^\infty$ under the coskeletal map. Let $\mathcal{R}$ be the fiber of $\text{cosk} \circ s \circ f$. By [Lemma 3.16](#), the composite

$$\text{EO} \wedge \mathbb{CP}_+^\infty \xrightarrow{f} \mathcal{F}_0 \xrightarrow{s} \text{EO} \wedge \mathbb{CP}_+^\infty \xrightarrow{\text{cosk}} \text{EO} \wedge \mathbb{CP}_{\hat{\beta}_k}^\infty$$

induces a surjection on $K_*^{\text{EO}}(-)$. Hence, the map

$$\mathcal{R} \longrightarrow \text{EO} \wedge \mathbb{CP}_+^\infty,$$

induces an injection on $K_*^{\text{EO}}(-)$. Because $\text{EO} \wedge \mathbb{CP}_+^{\hat{\beta}_k-1}$ is the fiber of cosk , there is a map

$$\alpha : \mathcal{R} \longrightarrow \text{EO} \wedge \mathbb{CP}_+^{\hat{\beta}_k-1}.$$

Since $K_*^{\text{EO}}(\text{cosk} \circ s \circ f) = K_*^{\text{EO}}(\text{cosk})$, the induced map

$$K_*^{\text{EO}} \alpha : K_*^{\text{EO}} \mathcal{R} \longrightarrow K_*^{\text{EO}}(\text{EO} \wedge \mathbb{CP}_+^{\hat{\beta}_k-1}) \cong K_* \mathbb{CP}_{\hat{\beta}_k-1}^\infty$$

is an isomorphism of K_* -modules. By [Corollary 4.13](#), α is a weak equivalence of EO-modules.

Because $f \circ s'$ is null, the composite $(\text{cosk} \circ s \circ f) \circ s'$ is also null and therefore there is a map $\mathcal{M}_0 \rightarrow \mathcal{R}$. Now let $\bar{s}': \mathcal{M}_0 \rightarrow \mathcal{R} \xrightarrow{\simeq} \text{EO} \wedge \mathbb{CP}_+^{\hat{\beta}_k-1}$ and define s'' to be the composite

$$\mathcal{M}_0 \xrightarrow{\bar{s}'} \text{EO} \wedge \mathbb{CP}_+^{\hat{\beta}_k-1} \longrightarrow \text{EO} \wedge \mathbb{CP}_+^\infty.$$

It is easy to see that $K_*^{\text{EO}}(\text{Cofib}(s'')) \cong K_*^{\text{EO}}\mathcal{F}_0$. Thus, by [Lemma 4.16](#),

$$\text{Cofib}(s'') \simeq \mathcal{F}_0 \simeq \bigvee_{\mathbb{N}} E$$

so $\text{Cofib}(s'')$ is a split summand of $\text{EO} \wedge \mathbb{CP}_+^\infty$. $\square$

Lemma 4.21. *The HF_p -Thom isomorphism $H_{*+c}\mathbb{CP}_c^\infty \cong H_*\mathbb{CP}_+^\infty$ is a map of $\mathcal{B}(k)$ -modules if c is divisible by p .*

Proof. Since the action of $\mathcal{B}(k)$ on $H_*(-)$ is obtained from the action of $\mathcal{B}(k)$ on $H^*(-)$ via the isomorphism

$$H_*(-) \cong \text{Hom}_{\mathbb{F}_p}(H^*(-), \mathbb{F}_p),$$

it is enough to show the HF_p -Thom isomorphism in cohomology

$$\tau: H^*\mathbb{CP}_+^\infty \xrightarrow{\cong} H^{*+c}\mathbb{CP}_c^\infty$$

is a map of $\mathcal{B}(k)$ -modules when p divides c . Note that $P_k(u_c) = cx^{p^k-1} \cdot u_c$, where $u_c \in H^*\mathbb{CP}_{pc}^\infty$ is the Thom class. Therefore, $P_k(u_c) = 0$ when c is divisible by p and

$$\tau(P_k(x^i)) = P_k(x^i) \cdot u_c = P_k(x^i \cdot u_c) = P_k(\tau(x^i)),$$

as desired. $\square$

Our next goal is to prove the following EO-Thom isomorphism.

Theorem 4.22. *There exists an equivalence of EO-modules*

$$(4.23) \quad \text{EO} \wedge \mathbb{CP}_r^\infty \simeq \text{EO} \wedge \Sigma^{2r}\mathbb{CP}_+^\infty,$$

where $r = \Theta(\gamma^{\hat{\beta}_k-1}, \text{EO})$.

Proof. Since $r = \Theta(\gamma^{\hat{\beta}_k-1}, \text{EO})$, we have an EO-Thom isomorphism

$$(4.24) \quad \text{EO} \wedge \mathbb{CP}_r^{\hat{\beta}_k-1+r} \simeq \text{EO} \wedge \Sigma^{2r}\mathbb{CP}_+^{\hat{\beta}_k-1}.$$

Using [Corollary 4.19](#) and [Lemma 4.20](#), we construct the composite map

$$c: \mathcal{M}_r \xrightarrow{\bar{s}'} \text{EO} \wedge \mathbb{CP}_r^{\hat{\beta}_k-1+r} \xrightarrow{\simeq} \text{EO} \wedge \Sigma^{2r}\mathbb{CP}_+^{\hat{\beta}_k-1} \longrightarrow \text{EO} \wedge \Sigma^{2r}\mathbb{CP}_+^\infty.$$

By [Remark 2.8](#), (4.24) respects the Atiyah-Hirzebruch filtration, therefore we analyze the image of the map induced by c on AHSS calculating $K_*^{\text{EO}}(-)$ -groups.

Since $\mathcal{M}_r$ does not have a natural Atiyah-Hirzebruch filtration, we induce one

$$\mathcal{M}_r^{(0)} \longrightarrow \dots \longrightarrow \mathcal{M}_r^{(\hat{\beta}_k-1)} = \mathcal{M}_r^{(\hat{\beta}_k)} = \dots = \mathcal{M}_r$$

by pulling back the Atiyah-Hirzebruch filtration on $\text{EO} \wedge \Sigma^{2r}\mathbb{CP}_+^\infty$. The associated graded of the corresponding filtration on $K_*^{\text{EO}}\mathcal{M}_r$, denote it by $\text{gr } K_*^{\text{EO}}\mathcal{M}_r$, is a $\text{gr } K_*[C_p]$ -module, and the induced map

$$(4.25) \quad \text{gr } K_*^{\text{EO}}(c): \text{gr } K_*^{\text{EO}}\mathcal{M}_r \longrightarrow \text{gr } K_*\Sigma^{2r}\mathbb{CP}_+^\infty,$$

is an injection with image $\Sigma^{2r}M_0^{\text{gr}K}$. This is because of the explicit description of $\Sigma^{2r}M_0^{\text{gr}K}$ as in the proof of [Proposition 3.21](#) and [Lemma 4.21](#). The cofiber of c also admits a filtration

$$\text{Cofib}(c) := \text{colim}_n \{ \text{Cofib}(c)^{(0)} \longrightarrow \text{Cofib}(c)^{(1)} \longrightarrow \dots \},$$

where $\text{Cofib}(c)^{(i)} = \text{Cofiber}(\mathcal{M}_r^{(i)} \rightarrow \text{EO} \wedge \Sigma^{2r}\mathbb{CP}_+^i)$, such that the associated graded of the induced filtration on $K_*^{\text{EO}} \text{Cofib}(c)$ is a free $\text{gr}K_*[C_p]$ -module isomorphic to $\Sigma^{2r}F_0^{\text{gr}K}$. Thus, by [Lemma 3.24](#) and [Lemma 4.16](#)

$$\text{Cofib}(c) \simeq \Sigma^{2r}\mathcal{F}_0$$

is a split summand of $\text{EO} \wedge \Sigma^{2r}\mathbb{CP}_+^\infty$. Therefore, we have an equivalence

$$\text{EO} \wedge \Sigma^{2r}\mathbb{CP}_+^\infty \simeq \mathcal{M}_r \vee \Sigma^{2r}\mathcal{F}_0 \simeq \mathcal{M}_r \vee \mathcal{F}_r \simeq \text{EO} \wedge \mathbb{CP}_r^\infty$$

as desired. $\square$

Corollary 4.26. $\Theta(\gamma, \text{EO}) = \Theta(\gamma^{\hat{\beta}_k-1}, \text{EO})$.

Proof. Immediate from [Theorem 4.22](#) and the fact that $M(r\gamma) \cong \mathbb{CP}_r^\infty$. $\square$

[Main Theorem 1.6](#) follows from [Corollary 4.26](#) because $\Theta(\text{EO}, \gamma^{\hat{\beta}_k-1})$ divides $\Theta(\mathbb{S}_p, \gamma^{\hat{\beta}_k-1}) = p^{p^k-1}$ (see [Example 2.13](#)).

4.3. The S^1 -Tate fixed points of EO

We shift our focus to identifying the S^1 -Tate spectrum of EO. If a group G acts on a spectrum X , the Tate spectrum $X^{\text{t}G}$ of X is the cofiber of the norm map from the homotopy orbits spectrum $X_{\text{h}G}$ of X to the homotopy fixed points spectrum $X^{\text{h}G}$ of X

$$X^{\text{t}G} := \text{Cofib}(\text{Nm}: X_{\text{h}G} \rightarrow X^{\text{h}G}).$$

If $G = S^1$ and the action on X is trivial, [\[GM95\]](#) gives an alternate description of the Tate fixed points:

$$(4.27) \quad X^{\text{t}S^1} \simeq \lim_{c \rightarrow \infty} \Sigma^2 R \wedge \mathbb{CP}_{-c}^\infty.$$

Inverse limits do not commute with $\pi_*(-)$. Instead, there is a short exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow \lim_c^1 (R_* \mathbb{CP}_{-c}^\infty) \rightarrow \pi_* R^{\text{t}S^1} \rightarrow \lim_c (R_* \mathbb{CP}_{-c}^\infty) \rightarrow 0$$

called the “Milnor sequence”.

Proof of Main Theorem 1.8. By Lemma 4.20 we can choose a splitting of $\mathrm{EO} \wedge \mathbb{CP}_{i\hat{\beta}_k}^\infty$ for all $i \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that we have the commutative diagram (4.28)

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc}
 \cdots & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{M}_{(i-1)\hat{\beta}_k} & \xrightarrow{0} & \mathcal{M}_{i\hat{\beta}_k} & \xrightarrow{0} & \mathcal{M}_{(i+1)\hat{\beta}_k} \longrightarrow \cdots \\
 & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow \\
 \cdots & \longrightarrow & \mathrm{EO} \wedge \mathbb{CP}_{(i-1)\hat{\beta}_k}^\infty & \longrightarrow & \mathrm{EO} \wedge \mathbb{CP}_{i\hat{\beta}_k}^\infty & \longrightarrow & \mathrm{EO} \wedge \mathbb{CP}_{(i+1)\hat{\beta}_k}^\infty \longrightarrow \cdots \\
 & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow \\
 \cdots & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{F}_{(i-1)\hat{\beta}_k} & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{F}_{i\hat{\beta}_k} & \longrightarrow & \mathcal{F}_{(i+1)\hat{\beta}_k} \longrightarrow \cdots
 \end{array}$$

such that the horizontal maps in the top row are null maps, in the middle row are coskeletal collapse maps.

The horizontal maps in the bottom row induce surjections in homotopy. To see this, we filter $\mathcal{F}_{i\hat{\beta}_k}$ using the Atiyah-Hirzebruch filtration of $\mathbb{CP}_{i\hat{\beta}_k}^\infty$. Let $\mathrm{gr} K_*^{\mathrm{EO}} \mathcal{F}_{i\hat{\beta}_k}$ denote the associated graded of the induced filtration on $K_*^{\mathrm{EO}} \mathcal{F}_{i\hat{\beta}_k}$. From Proposition 3.21, we observe that the composite

$$f_i: \mathcal{F}_{i\hat{\beta}_k} \longrightarrow \mathrm{EO} \wedge \mathbb{CP}_{i\hat{\beta}_k}^\infty \longrightarrow \mathrm{EO} \wedge \mathbb{CP}_{(i+1)\hat{\beta}_k}^\infty \longrightarrow \mathcal{F}_{(i+1)\hat{\beta}_k}$$

induces a surjection in $\mathrm{gr} K_*^{\mathrm{EO}}(-)$, and therefore a surjection in $K_*^{\mathrm{EO}}(-)$. By the Nakayama Lemma, f_i induces surjection on $E_*^{\mathrm{EO}}(-)$. By studying the induced map of relative Adams spectral sequence, we conclude that f_i is a surjection.

Consequently, we get a six-term exact sequence

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc}
 0 & \longrightarrow & \lim_i \pi_* \mathcal{M}_{-i\hat{\beta}_k} & \longrightarrow & \lim_i \mathrm{EO}_* \mathbb{CP}_{-i\hat{\beta}_k}^\infty & \longrightarrow & \lim_i \pi_* \mathcal{F}_{-i\hat{\beta}_k} \\
 & & & & & & \searrow \\
 & & & & & & \nearrow \\
 & & \lim_i^1 \pi_* \mathcal{M}_{-i\hat{\beta}_k} & \longrightarrow & \lim_i^1 \mathrm{EO}_* \mathbb{CP}_{-i\hat{\beta}_k}^\infty & \longrightarrow & \lim_i^1 \pi_* \mathcal{F}_{-i\hat{\beta}_k} \longrightarrow 0.
 \end{array}$$

From Diagram (4.28),

$$\lim_i \pi_* \Sigma^{-2ir} \mathcal{M}_0 = 0$$

$$\lim_i^1 \pi_* \Sigma^{-2ir} \mathcal{M}_0 = 0$$

$$\lim_i^1 \pi_* \mathcal{F}_{-ir} = 0$$

and

$$\lim_i \mathcal{F}_{-i\hat{\beta}_k} \simeq \prod_{-\infty < k < \infty} E.$$

Thus, $\lim_i^1 \mathrm{EO}_* \mathbb{CP}_{-i\hat{\beta}_k}^\infty = 0$ and

$$\mathrm{EO}^{\mathrm{ts}^1} \simeq \lim_i \mathrm{EO} \wedge \mathbb{CP}_{-i}^\infty \simeq \lim_i \mathrm{EO} \wedge \mathbb{CP}_{-i\hat{\beta}_k}^\infty \simeq \lim_i \mathcal{F}_{-i\hat{\beta}_k} \simeq \prod_{-\infty < k < \infty} E$$

as desired. $\square$

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UNIVERSITY OF VIRGINIA

E-mail address: pb9wh@virginia.edu

MASSACHUSETTS INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY

E-mail address: hood@mit.edu